MIL-C-81317(AS)
Amendment 2
19 May 1967
Superseding
Amendment 1
12 September 1966

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGE, IMPULSE, MARK 97 MOD 0

This amendment forms a part of Military Specification MIL-C-81317(WP) dated 30 August 1965 and has been approved by the Naval Air Systems Command, Department of the Navy.

By this amendment basic specification MIL-C-81317(WP) is changed to read MIL-C-81317(AS).

Page 1, in block, change "FSC 1375" to read "FSC 1377".

Page 2, paragraph 2.1, under DRAWINGS, subtitle Ordnance Corps of the Army, delete "B7645339 Primer (Styphnate) for Caliber 50" and add "B7645332 Primer, Percussion".

Page 3, paragraph 2.1, second sentence, delete "Dwg. B7645339" and add "Dwg. B7645332".

Pages 9, 10, 11, and 12, delete paragraphs 6.5 through 6.5.7.8 in their entirety and insert in lieu thereof the following:

"6.5 Explosives safety precautions.

6.5.1 Applicability. The loading, assembly and handling of the explosives, subassemblies and the finished items covered by this specification involve hazardous operations and therefore require suitable explosive safety precautions. At plants of the Naval Air Systems Command, Department of the Navy, and other Government plants where the Government is responsible for safety, the precautions listed below are mandatory. These same minimum provisions are recommended for observance by a contractor or manufacturer that explosively loads the item covered in this specification in order to fulfill his own safety responsibility. Other warnings and precautions, pertaining to the operational effectiveness or safety of the specified item during its use (for example, during its handling, launching or firing), are included in the detailed technical requirements of the specification. Use of this specification shall not be construed to replace other safety regulations of governmental agencies or to relieve the contractor or manufacturer of responsibility for the safety of his operations.

FSC 1377

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6.5.2 Personnel and equipment. Proper care must be exercised at all times to protect personnel from accidents, fires or explosions and to limit damage to equipment and loading areas. In connection with the above, the precautionary measures in the following paragraphs should be observed. (See also paragraph 6.5.4, Static and electrical and other applicable parts of these safety precautions.)

6.5.2.1 Explosives operations shall be kept under strict supervision. Periodic inspections shall be employed to assure compliance with established safety regulations.

6.5.2.2 Safe equipment and methods should be utilized for handling and transporting explosives and loaded parts.

6.5.2.3 Where required, remote control-barricaded-handling equipment shall be used for explosives operations such as mixing, pouring, weighing, charging, sifting, drying, pressing, casting, crimping, etc.

6.5.2.4 Employ properly proportioned and properly located protective barricades, screens or shields at all required points.

6.5.2.5 Maintain equipment such as presses, dies, crimpers, blenders, mixers, sifters, conveyors, and the like in safe operating condition.

6.5.2.6 Enforce, where necessary, the wearing of suitable safety footwear, gloves, goggles, respirators, and impregnated garments to protect personnel against burns, poisoning and associated industrial hazards.

6.5.2.7 During static tests, propulsion units such as rocket motors shall be restrained against full thrust to prevent flight if ignited, for example, during test of igniter circuit. Also, means shall be provided to harmlessly vent flames and exhaust gases.

6.5.3 Operating procedures. All loading operations shall be conducted in full accordance with a formalized operating procedure which shall include the following:

6.5.3.1 Keep only minimum, limited quantities of explosives and completed or partially loaded parts present at each stage of operations.

6.5.3.2 Allow no fires, exposed electrical or other sparking equipment, and little or no flammable material to be present in loading, handling and storage spaces. Enforce proper "Match" and "No Smoking" rules where necessary.



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6.5.3.3 Appropriate safety instructions for specific operations shall be posted and personnel instructed as to the hazards present and precautions involved.

6.5.3.4 The number of working personnel and transients permitted in each work space shall be established and posted in such areas. The numbers shall be the minimum number required to accomplish necessary operations.

6.5.3.5 All loading operations should be conducted in a neat and orderly manner.

6.5.3.6 Enforce good housekeeping and maintain effective policing, inspection and supervisory methods throughout the loading area and surroundings.

6.5.3.7 Employ effective cleaning methods periodically to minimize the accumulation of explosives or explosive dust and other contamination upon, and assure its removal from, floors, walls, ceiling, ledges, tables, benches, piping, and equipment or the items loaded. Clean up any spilled material immediately.

6.5.3.8 The exposure of explosive materials and related parts should be so controlled as to minimize the absorption of moisture from the atmosphere or other sources during loading and handling operations.

6.5.3.9 Personnel handling detonators, primers, delay elements, lead-ins, boosters, and related parts which affect functioning should, insofar as practicable, avoid using bare fingers or improper equipment in order to prevent damage, corrosion, or deterioration from perspiration or other contaminating deposits.

6.5.3.10 Keep explosives and explosive parts in approved covered receptacles with covers in place when material is not being taken out of or put into the receptacles. Where necessary, receptacles should be conductive to ground electrostatic charges. (See paragraph 6.5.4).

6.5.4 Static and electrical.

6.5.4.1 Protect operations from electrostatic charges by effectively grounding all machinery, equipment, and fixtures; and, where necessary, employ suitable grounded conductive coverings for floors, work benches and tables, and workers' conductive shoes. Workers' clothing of a type to minimize the accumulation of static charges shall be employed. Fabrics, such as silk and nylon, which promote static generation shall be avoided. Additional grounding devices such as grounded bracelets for



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workers should be employed where operations are conducted with items which are unusually sensitive to initiation by static electricity. Such items include initiating explosives, tracer mixtures, and low energy type of electric primers, detonators and squibs. The latter types of items shall have the free ends of lead wires bared and twisted together, and be packed in relatively small groups wrapped in bare non-insulated aluminum foil or other uncoated metal foil. During assembly and processing operations, such sensitive electric items should be short circuited by clips or other devices until installed with safety shunt in the final device. Additional precautions for these items should include mechanical shielding to contain or deflect fragments and blast; also electrical shielding from induced electric currents originated by sources such as lightning, static, electromagnetic radiations, etc. Where necessary for safety, humidity of work rooms should be appropriately increased, as required to lessen electrostatic effects, but without inducing excessive moisture absorption by any of the components of the item being processed.

6.5.4.2 Protect all explosive operations from effects of electric current originating in equipment (such as soldering irons or guns, heaters, switches, wiring, motors, lights, test instruments, etc.) by suitable insulation, grounding, separation or shielding. Such electric sources may initiate explosives by heat, sparks, arcs, or by completing an electric circuit through an electric primer, detonator or squib. For example, circuits may be inadvertently completed from a defective electric soldering iron through a grounded contact. All electric type of primers, detonators or squibs provided with wire leads shall have the free ends of the wires bared and twisted together to short circuit each unit, except when in process of assembly into a finished item. Removable short circuiting clips or other devices should be employed during manufacturing operations involving items such as electric primers, detonators or squibs.

6.5.4.3 Where necessary, protect personnel and operations from electromagnetic energy. In certain work with very sensitive explosives or items, a shielded environment free from significant electromagnetic energy should be provided.

6.5.5 Operating facility and storage regulations.

6.5.5.1 All explosives including partially loaded items should be stored in suitable storage magazines located in accordance with the minimum distances prescribed in the American Table of Distances (ATD). While the explosive or loaded items are in process, stored in loading rooms, or in ready or service magazines, they should be located in accordance with Intraplant Distances set forth in the ATD. For Navy



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managed or contractor managed-Navy owned-explosives loading plants, the Armed Services Explosives Safety Board standards approved by the Department of Defense, the Secretary of the Navy and the Naval Air Systems Command covering quantity-distance regulations for explosives apply."



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